



8 GB Nexus 7

Google seems to have run out of stock of its 8 GB Nexus 7 tablet on the Google Play Store



Facebook 'want' button

Facebook is beginning to roll out tests of "want" and "collect" buttons in an attempt to bring users and retailers closer together

core processor, 2 GB of RAM, an 8 MP camera, and a 2100 mAh battery.

On the tablet front, Google might be coming out with a 32 GB version of the Nexus 7, probably pricing it the same as the current Nexus 7 that is on store shelves. We also heard that there might be a premium 10.1-inch Nexus tablet in the works made by Samsung. There is a wild rumour of a \$99 Nexus tablet as well, but don't bet all your money on that just yet. Finally, October 29 may also see the unveiling of a new Android version – Android Key Lime Pie – though this seems unlikely.

HTC J Butterfly and One X+

HTC finally unveiled its Galaxy Note rival this month, the HTC J Butterfly. It features a 5-inch 440 ppi high resolution full



HTC Butterfly J

HD 1920 X 1080 touchscreen display, and runs on Android 4.1 Jelly Bean OS with Sense 4, powered by a quad-core 1.5GHz Snapdragon S4 Pro APQ8064 processor. It has 2 GB of RAM,

and comes with 16 GB of inbuilt storage, along with a microSD card slot that supports storage upto 32GB.

There's also an 8 MP camera, which can take still images up to 3280x2464, and record videos in 1080p. The battery has a 2,020 mAh capacity. For connectivity, the HTC J Butterfly supports LTE connectivity, NFC, HDMI and Bluetooth 4.0. In the meanwhile, HTC has introduced a new version of the One X, called the One X+.

The HTC One X+ will ship with Jelly Bean right out-of-the-box. It will feature an 8 MP rear camera with an f/2.0 lens, along with a front facing 1.6 MP camera that does video at 720p @ 30fps. It features an NVIDIA Tegra 3 processor inside clocked at 1.7GHz, coupled with 1 GB of RAM. There is also 64 GB of inbuilt storage onboard, which is not expandable. The One X+ also includes a bigger 2,100 mAh battery, as well as Beats Audio. Europe will be seeing the new flagship from HTC hit the streets sometime later this month, but Indian availability is not yet known, as usual.

ASUS PadFone 2

ASUS has officially unveiled its next-generation smartphone-in-a-tablet, the PadFone 2. It features a 4.7-inch 720p Super IPS+ panel, a Qualcomm quad-core processor, a 13 MP BSI Sony camera sensor, as well as a 1.2 MP front camera. The camera is capable of recording 720p HD video at 60fps, and 1080p HD video at 30fps. It can also take up to 100 continuous full-resolution photos.

The device runs on Android 4.0 Ice Cream Sandwich, but ASUS has promised a Jelly Bean upgrade soon. Other notable features of the PadFone 2 include 2 GB of RAM,



ASUS Padfone 2

a 2,140mAh (fixed) battery, NFC and 50 GB of ASUS cloud storage. There's no support for microSD. For connectivity, the PadFone 2 features WCDMA 900/2,100MHz radios, and LTE 800/1,800/2,600MHz radios in the global model.

The tablet dock of the PadFone, or PadFone station has a 10.1-inch IPS display with a 1,280 x 800 pixel resolution. It is powered by a 5,000 mAh battery, and weighs in at just 514 grams. With the smartphone attached, the weight is about 649 grams, which is still more than 200 grams lighter than the original PadFone.

The PadFone 2 without the PadFone Station – the 16 GB, 32 GB and 64 GB variants – is priced between \$620 to \$750, while the phone-in-tablet combo costs an additional US \$210 to each version. The PadFone 2 will be launched before the end of December in Europe and Asia.

Indian launches

Relevantly, ASUS recently launched the PadFone in India priced at ₹64,999. The PadFone is powered by a dual-core 1.5

GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon S4 processor and has a 1 GB RAM, 32 GB of internal storage and an 8 MP digital camera with Fuji image processor, f/2.2 aperture and five-element lens.

Samsung has launched the Galaxy Note II in India, pricing it ₹39,990. The Galaxy Note II bears a 5.5-inch Super AMOLED display with a resolution of 1280x720 pixels (16:9). It is powered by a quad-core 1.6 GHz Exynos 4412 Quad processor and 2 GB of RAM, and runs on Android 4.1 Jelly Bean. It has an 8 MP auto-focus rear camera with LED flash, and a 1.9 MP front facing camera. The device comes with three storage options – 16 / 32 / 64 GB – the ₹39,990 pricing is for the 16GB version.

A billion smartphones?

A new report from the research and consulting firm Strategy Analytics says global smartphone sales have gone past the 1 billion mark – 1.038 billion to be precise – for the first time in the third quarter and the numbers are set to double by 2015-end. The figures translate into one out of every seven people globally carrying a smartphone.

"By the third quarter of 2011, we estimate there were 708 million smartphones in use worldwide. After a further year of soaring demand, the number of smartphones in use worldwide reached 1.038 billion units during the third quarter of 2012," Scott Bicheno, a senior analyst at Strategy Analytics, said in a statement.

The researcher also points out that there's still a huge scope for the growth of smartphones with smartphone penetration relatively low in emerging markets such as China, India and Africa. 